

Chipotle: make digital growth work in the restaurant

Member	Role (proposed team split)
Alifya Saify	Roadmap Sequencer
Disha Reddy	Governance Designer
Rishit Mathur	Dashboard Designer
Shima Kananiazari	Dashboard Designer / integration and review coordination

Proposal and rationale

Bottom line. A better app does not help much if the food is late. We connect ordering, kitchen work and Rewards so a problem in one does not slow the others. We propose eight initiatives in three phases, seven governance decisions with one accountable owner each, and gates that stop expansion when a pilot misses its checks.

Phase	Timing	What happens	What must be true to move on
Crawl Foundation	Q1 to Q3	I1 ordering, I2 digital make line and I3 Rewards data are built in parallel.	Orders routed correctly (99.5%), crews ready (90%), usable profiles (99.5%).
Walk Deployment	Q4 to Q6	I4 delivery in 20 restaurants, I5 Chipotlane at 5 sites, I6 Rewards offer for 50,000 members.	95% on-time delivery, 3-minute lane handoff, 2-point repeat-visit lift.
Run Scale	Q7 to Q8+	I7 fulfillment and I8 Rewards offers expand to approved US groups.	Separate approvals per channel; staffing rules, discount limits and offer throttling in place.

Case evidence. Chipotle's 2018 to 2023 annual reports and its 2024 proxy statement. These are historical sources; the sequence, pilot sizes, targets and owners are our proposal, and Q1 to Q8 are project quarters, not calendar dates.

Governance. CCTO owns interfaces, data and partners (D2, D3, D5); CFAO funding (D1); CEO prioritization (D4); COO launch readiness (D6); CBO Rewards offers (D7).

Dashboard and team note. The one-page dashboard is a separate file, qbr-dashboard.html, and uses made-up Q7 values. The brief lists three roles for four members, so Rishit and Shima share dashboard work; this split still needs the team's agreement.

Who owns the recurring decisions?

Decision / initiatives	CEO	CFAO	CCTO	COO	CBO	CHRO	CLO	FS
D1 How should we split next quarter's funding between platforms, offers and restaurant rollout? (I1 to I8)	C	A	R	R	C	C	I	C
D2 Which order, payment and kitchen interfaces are standard, and when is an exception allowed? (I1, I2, I4, I5, I7)	I	C	A	R	C	I	C	C
D3 Who can use Rewards data, how is it checked, and which records are left out? (I1, I3, I6, I8)	I	I	A	C	R	I	C	I
D4 Which initiative gets the next engineering team or restaurant trial slot? (I1 to I8)	A	C	R	R	R	C	I	C
D5 Which technology or delivery partners do we choose, keep, change terms with or stop using? (I1, I4, I7)	I	C	A	R	C	I	R	C
D6 Is the next group of restaurants ready to launch, or should we hold it? (I2, I4, I5, I7)	I	C	R	A	R	R	C	C
D7 Which Rewards offers run, at what discount, for which audiences? (I3, I6, I8)	I	C	R	C	A	I	C	I

R prepares and carries out the decision. **A** owns the decision; there is exactly one A per row. **C** gives input before the decision is made. **I** is told afterward and has no input rights. D1 to D5 are the five required decision types; D6 and D7 are specific to this case.

CEO: Chief Executive Officer | **CFAO:** Chief Financial and Administrative Officer | **CCTO:** Chief Customer and Technology Officer | **COO:** Chief Operating Officer | **CBO:** Chief Brand Officer | **CHRO:** Chief Human Resources Officer | **CLO:** Chief Legal Officer and General Counsel | **FS:** Chief Corporate Affairs and Food Safety Officer.

Titles follow the April 2024 executive structure (S6). These are proposed decision rights, not Chipotle's published approval policy. Food-safety and legal requirements stay mandatory: consultation does not make them optional, and the COO cannot waive them.

Why that person gets the final call

Decision / Accountable	Why this role	How it is enforced
D1 Budget A: CFAO	Someone must see all costs together; extra sales on one team's report can hide discount and workload costs elsewhere.	No project starts until Finance records its budget and benefit check; Finance records every transfer and updates the forecast.
D2 Architecture A: CCTO	Owens the connections that move an order across systems; one restaurant or partner should not create an exception the business must maintain.	Interface changes need a recorded technical approval and end-to-end test results; exceptions expire unless the CCTO renews them.
D3 Data A: CCTO	Owens the customer technology and data controls used by every campaign; Brand defines the audience and Legal checks permitted use.	Access requests name a purpose and owner; audience checks block profiles with missing permission; unresolved data errors stay out of campaigns.
D4 Prioritization A: CEO	Can settle trade-offs between digital growth, restaurant workload and the wider plan; separate sponsors would promise the same people and sites twice.	A shared project list shows what is next and which teams are free; a priority change needs a recorded CEO decision.
D5 Vendors A: CCTO	Owens whether a partner fits the ordering service and can be supported; Finance, Operations and Legal prepare the economics and terms.	Contracts need service measures, data-use limits, a tested exit route and a spending limit; repeated service failures trigger a renewal review.
D6 Launch readiness A: COO	Affects the people running the restaurant; equipment is not enough, staff must be ready and food must be on time.	The checklist needs crew proficiency, channel-specific pilot results and food-safety checks; the COO signs each release; a missed gate blocks that channel.
D7 Rewards offers A: CBO	Decides which offers fit the brand and give customers a reason to return; Finance checks profit and Operations checks capacity.	Each offer needs customer rules, a budget, a no-offer comparison group and a stop point; no launch without Brand approval and data checks.

Before a decision is closed, its owner records the evidence, the people consulted, the answer and any conditions, with the decision ID and the affected initiative IDs, in the launch record and quarterly business review. If a condition is missed, the relevant release waits.

What the company reported, and what we added

Source	Document and section	Supports
S1	Chipotle 2018 Form 10-K, Item 1: Guest Experience and Operations; Innovation. Read source	I1, I5: mobile ordering, digital payments, Chipotlanes
S2	Chipotle 2019 Annual Report, p. 5: Innovation and Marketing (PDF p. 7). Read source	I2, I3, I6: digital make lines, Rewards launch, individual-level marketing
S3	Chipotle 2020 Form 10-K, Item 1: Digital Business. Read source	I4, I5, I7: third-party delivery, digital make lines, Chipotlanes
S4	Chipotle 2021 Form 10-K, p. 21: 2021 Financial Highlights. Read source	I6, I8: June 2021 redemption choices and personalized offers
S5	Chipotle 2023 Annual Report, pp. 5 and 9: Digital Business and risks (PDF pp. 7 and 11). Read source	I1, I7, I8: app improvements, delivery, Chipotlanes, cost and service risks
S6	Chipotle 2024 Proxy Statement, pp. 51 to 52: Executive Officers (PDF pp. 55 to 56). Read source	RACI role titles as of April 1, 2024

Limits of the case

The reports are historical and do not establish our order, pilot sizes, targets, budget, internal system design or approval matrix; these are our proposals. We split broader company programs into setup, pilot and rollout packages so dependencies can be tested. Higher digital sales alone would not show whether an offer or pickup lane caused a change, so we compare customers who got an offer with those who did not and check service times and costs. We do not claim Chipotle used this sequence.

The one-page dashboard is a separate file, qbr-dashboard.html; this PDF contains the roadmap, RACI and supporting notes.